Chushul region was linked to the Spanggur Sector. Extending southwards from Yula III, the main Indian posts on the Rezang ridge were Ration Party, Gurung Hill, Trench Hill, Foot Hill, Paw Hill, Gompa Hill and, south of the Spanggur Gap, Rezang-la and Tsaka-la. The Chushul airfield was the designated vital ground. The area south of Tsaka-la was the Demchok (or Indus Valley) Sector.

The reported use of armour against Srijap West had underlined the true extent of Chinese preparations. Intelligence reports were also confirming the presence of tanks in the Spanggur area. On 22 October, the XV Corps commander, Bikram Singh, visited Raina and informed him that Chushul airfield needed to prepare itself to receive some heavy equipment. Indian Air Force pilots flying transport planes into Chushul said there was a three-kilometre-long column of Chinese military vehicles moving into the Spanggur area. At 1 p.m., Bravo Company of 1/8 GR on Paw Hill also relayed the same information to HQ 114 Brigade.

By 24 October, 13 Kumaon had completed its induction into Chushul. Gurung Hill, Trench Hill and Foot Hill remained with the Gorkhas while Paw Hill and Rezang-la were made the responsibility of the Kumaonis. A battery (six guns) of medium artillery from 13 Field Regiment and a Mahar MMG platoon arrived, but all eyes were now on the IAF that was expected to do the impossible the next day—fly in the armour.

Six AMX-13 light tanks, weighing 14.5 tons each, belonging to 20 Lancers were loaded onto AN-12 aircraft at Chandigarh. This had never been done before and it was not known how the aircraft would behave on take off or landing with such a heavy load. The Chushul runway was situated at 13,700 feet and to compensate for the weight of the aircraft, it was decided to fly with partial fuel. PSP (pierced steel plank) strips fabricated from corrugated iron made up the landing surface and even aircraft with lighter loads were known to bounce about after touchdown. The unknown factors were many and as apprehension mounted, Squadron Leader Chandan Singh volunteered to be the first pilot to take off with an AMX-13 on board.

Chandan Singh got airborne from Chandigarh and after an uneventful flight, touched down smoothly at Chushul at 11.10 a.m. on 25 October. He had fifteen minutes to offload the tank and take off, clearing the way for the next aircraft. By the time the last aircraft approached, 400 feet of the runway had become unserviceable and Squadron Leader D. W. Chauhan